

STUDENT BRIEFING – DISTRIBUTE ON CARNIVAL DAY

Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing

Read this before you enter the water. It will take 2 minutes and could save a life.

Today's Rules — Everyone Must Know These

 **Stay in your designated area.** Only enter the water when instructed by your teacher or event marshal. Do not enter the warm-up or racing lanes unless it is your turn.

 **No diving in shallow water.** Check depth before any entry. Feet-first entry only unless you are in a designated dive start lane confirmed by staff.

 **Always have a buddy.** Know who your buddy is. If you can't see them, tell a teacher immediately.

 **Signal for help if you need it.** Raise ONE arm. Do not be embarrassed — it is always better to ask for help.

 **Phones away near the pool edge.** Distraction is a major factor in pool incidents. Phones are for spectator areas only.

 **Medical conditions.** If you have asthma, a heart condition, or any health issue — check in with your teacher before the carnival begins. Do not swim if you feel unwell.

 **No running on the pool deck.** Walk at all times. Wet pool decks cause falls that result in serious injuries every year.

Know These Locations

- **First aid station:**
_____ (teacher to fill in)
- **AED (defibrillator):**

- **Emergency exit:**

- **Teacher in charge:**

- **Lifeguard on duty:**

Before You Swim

- Know your event number and heat
- Have goggles & swim cap ready
- Apply sunscreen (outdoor pool)
- Stay hydrated — drink water regularly
- Warm up gently — no cold water shock
- Tell your teacher if you feel unwell at any point

If You See Someone in Trouble

- **Shout** to attract a lifeguard or teacher's attention immediately — loudly and clearly: "HELP — SWIMMER IN TROUBLE!"
- **Do NOT jump in** to help — alert trained staff only. Untrained rescuers become casualties themselves.
- **Throw** the nearest buoyant object (life ring, kickboard, pool noodle) if the person is near the edge
- If no staff are immediately visible, one person calls 000 while others continue shouting for adult help

000

Emergency: Call 000

Your location: name of pool/school + suburb + street address. What happened. How many people are injured. Whether they are breathing. **Stay on the line.**

I have read and understood the Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing:

STUDENT NAME

CLASS

DATE

STUDENT SIGNATURE



Carnival Day

Teacher Checklist

Complete all pre-carnival checks. Keep this document accessible during the event. Review DE Swimming excursion policy annually.

Pre-Carnival Preparation (1 week before)

- ☐ Confirm venue has qualified lifeguard(s) in attendance for duration of carnival
- ☐ Confirm AED location at the venue — test that it is operational
- ☐ Collect and review all student medical forms (asthma, cardiac, epilepsy, allergies)
- ☐ Identify students who cannot swim or have water anxiety — assign buddy and inform all supervising staff
- ☐ Brief all supervising staff on emergency procedures and their roles
- ☐ Confirm first aid kit is stocked and present on the day
- ☐ Distribute student safety briefing sheet — collect signed acknowledgements
- ☐ Complete and file the DE risk management documentation
- ☐ Confirm student-to-supervisor ratios comply with DE requirements
- ☐ Identify emergency evacuation routes at the venue

Supervision Ratios (DE Policy)

- Check current DE Swimming Policy for approved ratios
- At minimum: one qualified first aider must be present at all times
- Designated Water Watcher: one adult whose sole responsibility is scanning the water — no other tasks
- Rotate water watcher role every 15–20 minutes to maintain vigilance
- Never leave pool area unsupervised even momentarily

[DE Swimming Policy](#) ↗

Venue Layout — Fill In On Arrival

AED location: _____

First aid room:

Lifeguard station:

Emergency exit:

Venue phone:

Pool address (for 000):

Staff Roles on Carnival Day

Event Coordinator

- Overall oversight of running order
- Liaises with venue staff
- Manages timetable and results
- Point of contact for parents

Water Watcher

- Scans the water continuously
- No other tasks while watching
- Rotates every 15–20 min
- Calls 000 or signals lifeguard if needed

First Aider

- Trained and qualified staff only
- Knows AED location
- Manages medical kit
- Responds immediately if called

On-the-Day Checklist (morning of carnival)

- ☐ Roll call — confirm all students present and accounted for
- ☐ Collect any new medical information from parents on arrival
- ☐ Brief all students with the Safety Briefing sheet (or read aloud)
- ☐ Walk venue — confirm AED, first aid room, emergency exits are accessible
- ☐ Confirm lifeguard is on deck and briefed on school group
- ☐ Assign Water Watcher — brief on role and rotation
- ☐ Confirm non-swimmers are identified with coloured caps or wristbands
- ☐ Run brief DRS ABCD refresher with student helpers/water safety monitors

If an Incident Occurs

1. **SHOUT for the lifeguard** — they are the first responder in a pool environment
2. **Clear the pool** — all other students out of water immediately
3. **Call 000** — one designated person only; others manage the crowd
4. **Begin DRS ABCD** if lifeguard is not immediately available
5. **Send someone to the entrance** to guide emergency services in
6. **Notify school administration** as soon as emergency services are en route
7. **Do not move the casualty** unless they are in immediate further danger
8. **Document everything** — time, observations, actions taken — as soon as incident is stable

Post-Carnival Obligations

- Complete a written incident report for ANY first aid treatment (including minor)
- Notify school administration of any incidents on the same day
- Serious incidents must be reported to DE — follow your school's Critical Incident protocol
- Debrief with supervising staff — identify any improvements for next year
- Return risk management documentation to the office
- Reference: [DE Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy ↗](#)



Emergency Reference Card

Print at A4 and laminate. Post at poolside and first aid station. Accessible to all staff.

000

Emergency Services — Call 000

Pool name: _____ | Street: _____ | Suburb: _____

Tell them: location, what happened, number of casualties, whether breathing. **Stay on the line.**



DRS ABCD — Emergency Action Plan

D

DANGER

R

RESPONSE

S

SEND 000

A

AIRWAY

B

BREATHING

C

CPR

D

DEFIB

CPR: 30 chest compressions + 2 rescue breaths. Hard and fast, 100–120 bpm, 5–6cm depth. Continue until ambulance arrives.



Pool Incident — Immediate Steps

1. Shout for lifeguard immediately
2. Clear the pool of all students
3. Call 000
4. Lifeguard/first aider begins DRS ABCD
5. Send person to entrance for ambulance
6. Keep bystanders clear
7. Do not move casualty unless in danger



Key Contacts — Fill In Before Carnival

Lifeguard name: _____

Lifeguard mobile: _____

Teacher in charge: _____

TIC mobile: _____

School office: _____

AED location: _____

AED (Defibrillator) — How to Use

1. **Ensure the casualty is out of the water** and lying on a dry surface before using
2. Turn on the AED — it will give voice instructions; follow them exactly
3. Attach the pads as shown in the diagram on the pads themselves
4. Stand clear when the AED analyses the heart rhythm
5. If a shock is advised, ensure no-one is touching the casualty, then press the shock button
6. Continue CPR between AED instructions until ambulance arrives

AEDs are safe — they will only deliver a shock if the heart needs it.

Throw, Don't Go — Rescue Hierarchy

1. **Talk** — call instructions from poolside: "Float on your back! Raise your arm!"
2. **Reach** — extend a kickboard, pool noodle, or pole from the edge
3. **Throw** — throw the life ring or any buoyant object with a line attached
4. **Go** — enter the water **ONLY** if lifeguard-trained, never alone, always with flotation